

FREE GUIDE

The Home *Environmental* *Testing* Guide

Every Sacred Sampling kit, what it measures, and when to use it — so you can match the right test to what you actually want to know about your home.



WATER



AIR



ASBESTOS



DUST



SURFACE



SOIL

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*Built on Faith. Rooted in Science.
Inspected with Experience.*

01 · INTRODUCTION

What Testing Can Tell You — *and what it can't.*

Most of what shapes indoor environmental health can't be seen, tasted, or smelled. Testing is how you find out what is actually present, at what concentration, and how that concentration compares to a published benchmark.

Sacred Sampling kits are mail-in laboratory tests. You collect the sample at home in ten to fifteen minutes, ship it to our partner labs under chain-of-custody, and receive a plain-language report with your measured results, the reporting limit, the EPA-referenced method used, and — where a federal or state benchmark exists — the comparison. Instrument-based analysis (ICP-MS, GC-MS, HPLC, PLM, culture, and immunoassay) is what separates a lab result from a color-changing strip.

The catalog covers six domains: **water, indoor air, asbestos in building materials, dust and settled particulate, surface residues**, and **soil and radiological** testing. Not every home needs every test. This guide walks each category, what the kits actually measure, and how to choose the right one for the question in front of you.

WHAT WE REPORT, AND WHAT WE DON'T

Sacred Sampling reports the measurement — a concentration, a fiber type, a colony count. We do not diagnose health conditions, make medical claims, or tell you whether you are "safe." Interpretation belongs to you, your contractor, your inspector, or your physician. The kit's job is to give you a defensible, lab-grade number to work from.

02 · OVERVIEW

Six Testing Categories, One Workflow.

Every kit ships the same way, uses the same chain-of-custody, and returns the same plain-language report. The difference is what's inside the box and which accredited lab analyzes it.

Water

6 kits

LONG ISLAND ANALYTICAL LABS · ICP-MS & IC

Drinking water from a tap or well. Metals, minerals, PFAS, VOCs, disinfection byproducts, bacteria, hardness and pH.

Use when: Move-in, new well, taste/odor change, filter selection.

Indoor Air

6 kits

ASSAY TECHNOLOGY · PASSIVE BADGES

Formaldehyde, VOCs, mold spores, and multi-badge IAQ panels. Passive collection over a set exposure window — no pump, no meter.

Use when: New construction, renovation, headaches, visible mold, occupant complaints.

Asbestos

3 kits

LIAL / EMSL · PLM & PLM-NOB

Bulk material identification for suspect flooring, insulation, popcorn ceiling, siding, and joint compound in pre-1985 buildings.

Use when: Before renovation, demolition, or removal in a pre-1985 building.

Dust & Lead

5 kits

EMSL ANALYTICAL · WIPE & VACUUM

Settled dust from floors, sills, and troughs. Lead, metals, allergens, and endotoxin — collected by templated wipe or vacuum.

Use when: Pre-1978 home, post-renovation clearance, allergy or asthma concerns.

Surface & Residue

3+ kits

EMSL ANALYTICAL · NIOSH 9111M & MPL

Drug residue (meth, cocaine, fentanyl, heroin, THC) on surfaces, and cosmetic microbiology screening for finished consumer products.

Use when: Pre-purchase inspection, rental turnover, product QA.

Soil & Radon

3 kits

LIAL · RCR METALS · RADON DEVICE

Garden and yard soil for RCRA 8 metals, TPH, and VOCs; short-term radon test with device and analysis included.

Use when: Garden planning, urban soil, real-estate radon disclosure.

03 · WATER TESTING

Six Tiers, One Lab.

Drinking water from a tap or well, analyzed by Long Island Analytical Laboratories using EPA-referenced methods. Tiered from single-analyte to a full comprehensive panel.

Heavy Metals

43 · HM

METALS · PLUMBING / WELL

Thirteen-metal ICP-MS panel. The right first test for pre-1986 plumbing, lead service line concerns, or well water in metal-rich geology.

DETECTS

Lead, copper, arsenic, cadmium, chromium, mercury, nickel, and 6 more · EPA 200.7 / 245.1

Metals & Minerals

43 · MM

METALS + MINERALS

Adds the mineral chemistry that shapes taste, staining, and appliance life — calcium, magnesium, iron, manganese, and hardness — on top of the metals panel.

DETECTS

13 metals + Ca, Mg, Fe, Mn, hardness, pH

Essentials

43 · ES

GENERAL CHEMISTRY + BACTERIA

The homeowner baseline. Bacteria, nitrates, chloride, fluoride, and general chemistry — the annual well-water starting point recommended by most state health departments.

DETECTS

Coliform, E. coli, nitrate, chloride, fluoride, pH, hardness

Comprehensive

43 · CP

METALS + CHEMISTRY + VOCs

Metals, minerals, general chemistry, bacteria, and drinking-water VOCs in one submission. The most complete non-specialty panel we offer.

DETECTS

30+ analytes · EPA 200.7 / 245.1 / 524.2 / Colisure

PFAS

43 · PF

FOREVER CHEMICALS

Twenty-five per- and polyfluoroalkyl substances by EPA Method 533 — the defined federal compound list, including PFOA and PFOS at parts-per-trillion detection.

DETECTS

25 PFAS compounds · EPA 533 · reporting limit 2 ppt

Professional

43 · PR

EVERYTHING · REAL-ESTATE GRADE

Comprehensive plus PFAS, radiological screening, and disinfection byproducts. Built for real-estate transactions, expert reports, and pre-litigation documentation.

DETECTS

Comprehensive panel + PFAS + THMs + radiological screen

IF YOU'RE STARTING FROM SCRATCH

Well: Essentials annually, add Heavy Metals and PFAS on the first test for baseline. Municipal: Heavy Metals on move-in for pre-1986 homes, then Comprehensive every 2–3 years.

● INDOOR AIR · ASSAY TECHNOLOGY

04 · INDOOR AIR QUALITY

Passive Badges, Real Chemistry.

Passive sorbent badges collect air over a defined exposure window (typically 24 hours to 7 days) using validated NIOSH and OSHA methods. No pump, no calibration — you hang the badge, seal it, and mail it.

Formaldehyde Monitor

34 · FA

SINGLE ANALYTE · NEW BUILD / RENO

The right test for new cabinetry, laminate flooring, plywood subfloor, or a recent renovation. Formaldehyde off-gassing from engineered wood is the most common IAQ complaint.

DETECTS

Formaldehyde (HCHO) · NIOSH 2016

VOC Monitor

34 · VOC

VOLATILE ORGANIC COMPOUNDS

Total VOC screen for paint solvents, adhesives, cleaning products, and dry-cleaning residue. Best paired with the formaldehyde badge for a full off-gassing picture.

DETECTS

Total VOC (as toluene equivalent) · NIOSH 1500

Mold Air Sampling

38 · MO

FUNGAL SPORES

Two spore trap cassettes — one indoor, one outdoor control — analyzed by direct microscopy. Identifies the mold genera present and gives an indoor-vs-outdoor comparison.

DETECTS

Aspergillus, Penicillium, Stachybotrys, Cladosporium, and 15+ others

IAQ Baseline

34 · IAQ-B

3-BADGE SCREEN

Formaldehyde, total VOCs, and a general aldehyde badge. The homeowner starter panel for new construction move-in or unexplained irritation and headaches.

DETECTS

HCHO + TVOC + total aldehydes

IAQ Enhanced

34 · IAQ-E

4-BADGE PANEL

Adds an acid gas or nitrogen dioxide badge to the baseline set. Suited to homes with attached garages, gas cooking, or combustion heating.

DETECTS

HCHO + TVOC + aldehydes + NO₂ or acid gases

IAQ Comprehensive

34 · IAQ-C

4-BADGE EXTENDED

The most complete passive-badge IAQ panel we offer. For complex complaints, occupant health flags, or documentation supporting a professional consultation.

DETECTS

4-badge panel across HCHO, TVOC, aldehydes, and combustion markers

WHAT PASSIVE BADGES DO NOT MEASURE

Badges measure gases and vapors. They do not measure PM2.5/PM10, CO/CO₂, or radon — those need dedicated devices. Mold cassettes count spores, not mycotoxins.

● ASBESTOS · LIAL / EMSL

0 5 · ASBESTOS BUILDING MATERIALS

Before You Cut, Sand, or Demo —TEST

Asbestos was used in construction materials well into the 1980s. If your home predates 1985 and you're planning renovation, demolition, or removal of suspect materials, bulk sampling is the first step. All tiers are analyzed by NYS ELAP-accredited labs.

Asbestos Core

48010

PLM · BULK MATERIAL

Polarized light microscopy on one to three suspect materials — popcorn ceiling, vinyl floor tile, joint compound, insulation, mastic, or plaster. Homeowner starting point.

DETECTS

Chrysotile, amosite, crocidolite, and three other regulated fiber types · EPA 600/R-93/116

Asbestos Standard

48011

PLM-NOB WITH GRAVIMETRIC

PLM with non-friable organically-bound reduction — the required method in New York for floor tile, mastic, and roofing. Higher confidence on layered or organically-bound materials.

DETECTS

All PLM fiber types · NYS 198.6 · gravimetric reduction

Asbestos Advanced

48012

TEM · DEFINITIVE

Transmission electron microscopy — the definitive method when PLM returns "trace" or "none detected" on a suspect material. Use for pre-demolition documentation or dispute resolution.

DETECTS

All fiber types at sub-PLM detection limits · EPA 600/R-93/116

Multi-Material Bundle

48 · MM

WHOLE-HOME RENOVATION

Up to eight bulk samples analyzed under a single submission — for whole-home renovations, real-estate due diligence, or a pre-demolition survey where multiple materials need to be cleared at once.

DETECTS

Up to 8 materials · PLM · same-lab chain of custody

SAMPLING SAFELY

Wet the material, cut a coin-sized piece with the tool provided, and double-bag it. Never sand, break, or crush suspect material dry. If it's already friable or damaged, stop and consult a licensed abatement contractor before testing.

● DUST & LEAD · EMSL

06 · SETTLED DUST

What Has Fallen Out of the Air.

Air testing catches what's suspended right now. Dust testing catches what's settled over weeks or months. Wipe collection for metals and lead; vacuum collection for allergens and endotoxin — the two methods are not interchangeable.

Lead Dust Wipe

44017

3-WIPE TEMPLATE · POST-RENO

The strongest kit in the catalog for a real reason — it's the only one with a published federal benchmark (5 µg/ft² floors, 40 sills, 100 troughs). Use for post-renovation clearance in any pre-1978 home, or before a child moves into an older rental.

DETECTS

Lead in µg/ft² · EPA 7000B · 1 ft² template

Lead & Metals Dust Wipe

44027

4-ELEMENT PANEL · WIPE

Lead plus three commonly co-occurring metals in settled dust — for shooting-range decontamination, industrial-adjacent homes, or a broader clearance picture than lead alone.

DETECTS

Pb, As, Cd, Cr · EPA 6010D · wipe

Household Dust Composition

44026

PARTICLE ID · WIPE

Microscopic identification of what your dust actually is — skin cells, fibers, mineral dust, insect fragments, mold, insulation. The answer to "what am I breathing?" when the source is unknown.

DETECTS

Particle types by microscopy · EMSL M280

Home Allergen Dust

44028

4-ALLERGEN PANEL · VACUUMED

Multiplex immunoassay quantifying the four most clinically-referenced indoor allergens: dust mite, cat, dog, and cockroach. Reported per gram of dust — actionable in a way an air sample is not.

DETECTS

Der p 1, Fel d 1, Can f 1, Bla g 2 · EMSL M044

Allergen + Endotoxin Dust

44029

EXTENDED PANEL · VACUUMED

Adds bacterial endotoxin (a driver of asthma exacerbation independent of allergens) to the four-allergen panel. The most complete dust panel we sell.

DETECTS

4 allergens + endotoxin (LPS) · EMSL M044 + LAL

WIPE OR VACUUM — ONE OR THE OTHER

Metals collect on the wipe surface; allergens are quantified per gram of dust and need a weighed sample. Don't use a wipe to look for allergens or a vacuum cassette to look for lead — the numbers won't be interpretable either way.

● SURFACE · COSMETIC · SOIL · RADON

07 · SPECIALTY TESTING

The Rest of the Catalog.

The kits that don't fit the four big categories — but often answer the most specific real-world questions. Every one uses instrument-based analysis at an accredited lab.

Drug Residue Wipe

44 · DR

SURFACE · NIOSH 9111M

Screens surfaces for methamphetamine, cocaine, fentanyl, heroin, and THC. Common uses: pre-purchase inspection of a suspect home, rental turnover, or fentanyl exposure documentation after a known incident.

DETECTS

Meth, cocaine, fentanyl, heroin, THC · NIOSH 9111M · wipe

Cosmetic Screening

36010

MICROBIOLOGY · MPL PANEL

Aerobic plate count plus yeast and mold on a finished cosmetic, lotion, or personal-care product. For small-batch makers and consumers who want to verify a product's microbial baseline.

DETECTS

APC, yeast, mold · EMSL MPL Standard

Cosmetic Full Pathogen

36011

MICROBIOLOGY · PATHOGEN PANEL

Extended microbiology adding *S. aureus*, *P. aeruginosa*, *E. coli*, and *Salmonella*. For final-batch QA on a product going to sale.

DETECTS

MPL + 4 pathogens · EMSL culture & PCR

Soil Environmental Impact

37013

METALS + PETROLEUM + VOCs

RCRA 8 metals, total petroleum hydrocarbons, and soil VOCs on a garden, yard, or new-construction lot. The right test before planting an urban food garden or after a fuel-tank removal.

DETECTS

RCRA metals + TPH + VOCs · EPA 6010 / 8015 / 8260

Garden Soil Lead

37 · GL

SINGLE ANALYTE · URBAN GARDEN

Focused lead screen for garden beds and play yards in urban or older suburban lots. Compares to EPA's 400 ppm residential soil-lead benchmark.

DETECTS

Lead (Pb) in soil · EPA 6010D

Radon Home Test

39010

SHORT-TERM · PREPAID DEVICE

Short-term (48–96 hour) radon test with the device and lab analysis included in the box. The EPA action level is 4 pCi/L — required on many real-estate disclosures in the Northeast, Upper Midwest, and Mountain West.

DETECTS

Radon-222 activity in pCi/L · EPA short-term protocol

08 · CHOOSING THE RIGHT KIT

Start With the Question.

Testing works when the kit matches the question. Here's the shortlist by concern — and how often to re-test once you have a baseline.

IF YOUR QUESTION IS...	START WITH
"Is the water in my new home safe to drink?"	Water Essentials (bacteria + nitrates + general chemistry); add Heavy Metals if pre-1986 plumbing.
"I have a well — what do I need to know?"	Water Comprehensive annually; add PFAS on the first test for baseline.
"New construction — is anything off-gassing?"	IAQ Baseline (formaldehyde + VOC + aldehydes badges) for 7 days after move-in.
"I see mold in the basement."	Mold Air Sampling (indoor + outdoor control). Test <i>before</i> remediation to establish baseline.
"I want to renovate a pre-1985 kitchen."	Asbestos Core on flooring, joint compound, and any pipe insulation before you cut.
"We just finished a renovation with a child in the home."	Lead Dust Wipe for clearance on floors, sills, and troughs.
"Someone in the house has severe allergies."	Home Allergen Dust in the primary bedroom; Allergen + Endotoxin if asthma is also present.
"We're buying a house — any surprises?"	Water Professional , Radon Home Test , plus Drug Residue Wipe if the seller history is unknown.
"I'm planting a vegetable garden in an old urban lot."	Garden Soil Lead first; Soil Environmental Impact if it's within 50 ft of former industrial use.

Cadence, once you have a baseline.

Well water

Essentials annually ·
Comprehensive every 3 years ·
retest bacteria after any well work
or flooding.

Municipal water

Every 2–3 years · re-test whenever
taste, color, or smell changes.

Indoor air (new build)

Baseline at move-in · re-test at 6
months and 1 year until
formaldehyde drops.

Lead dust

After any renovation or window work
in a pre-1978 home.

sacredsamplingsolutions.com

Asbestos

Before disturbance of suspect
material in a pre-1985 building.
One-time.

Radon

Every 2 years · after foundation,
HVAC, or basement work.

READY WHEN YOU ARE

Every Kit Ships to Your Door — *every result comes back to yours.*

Sacred Sampling kits ship with everything you need to collect a defensible sample in about fifteen minutes, prepaid return shipping, and a plain-language lab report at the end. Every analysis is performed by an accredited third-party laboratory using EPA-referenced methods.

[Browse The Full Catalog →](#)

● WATER · 6 KITS

Heavy Metals · Metals & Minerals · Essentials · Comprehensive · PFAS · Professional

● INDOOR AIR · 6 KITS

Formaldehyde · VOC · Mold · IAQ Baseline · IAQ Enhanced · IAQ Comprehensive

● ASBESTOS · 3 KITS

Core (PLM) · Standard (PLM NOB) · Advanced (TEM) · Multi-Material bundle

● DUST & LEAD · 5 KITS

Lead Dust Wipe · Lead & Metals Household Composition · Allergen · Allergen + Endotoxin

● COSMETIC · 3 KITS

Cosmetic Screening · Cosmetic Full Pathogen

● SOIL & RADON

Environmental Impact · Garden Soil Lead · Short-Term Radon

GET IN TOUCH

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OUR LABS

Long Island Analytical Laboratories — water, soil, asbestos
Assay Technology — indoor air badges
EMSL Analytical — dust, wipes, cosmetic microbiology